



WORLD RANGER CONGRESS

Training and Knowledge
Exchange Program

Rangers learning from
Rangers

FOUNDING EDITION

Iguazú · Argentina · 2027

AN INITIATIVE OF:



IN COLLABORATION WITH:



SUPPORTED BY:





"Strength lies in a united collective, working horizontally and collaboratively to transform the reality of the profession."

LATIN AMERICAN RANGER FEDERATION

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Official Training and Knowledge Exchange Program

Rangers learning from Rangers

The Official Training and Knowledge Exchange Program was created as an initiative of the Latin American Ranger Federation (FLG) and the Union of National Rangers of the Argentine Republic (SIGUNARA), the host organization responsible for leading the organization of the 11th World Ranger Congress Iguazú 2027. The program also benefits from the collaboration of the International Ranger Federation (IRF) and the European Ranger Federation (ERF), and from the valuable support of the National Parks Administration of Argentina, whose institutional commitment helps make this initiative possible.

This program grew out of the conviction that one of the most valuable ways to strengthen the ranger community's capacities is to create spaces where rangers can share knowledge, experiences, and tools built from everyday practice in protected areas and other conservation areas. It is under this premise that the concept giving this initiative its identity was born: Rangers learning from Rangers.

The response to the call for training proposals far exceeded the Organizing Committee's expectations. Numerous training proposals were received from different countries, reflecting the quality, diversity, and commitment of the ranger community to strengthening the profession. This response confirmed something worth highlighting: Latin America has rangers with solid experience, technical capacity, and a genuine willingness to share their knowledge with colleagues from the region and the world.

Although the interest and quality of the applications received would have allowed for a much larger program, for organizational and logistical reasons specific to the World Ranger Congress Iguazú 2027, this first edition brings together four training proposals. This selection marks the beginning of a program conceived with a vision for continuity, one that aspires to become a permanent space for training and knowledge exchange, incorporating in

future editions new topics, teaching teams, and learning opportunities.

The trainings that make up this program are free of charge and were built from the experience of rangers themselves, with an eminently practical, collaborative approach focused on peer-to-peer learning. They offer an opportunity to strengthen capacities, share good practices, and build cooperation networks among colleagues working in different protected areas and other conservation areas.

We hope that this Official Training and Knowledge Exchange Program will be an enriching experience for all participants, and that the path begun in Iguazú will continue to grow, strengthening the capacities of the ranger community and fostering a culture of collaborative learning that extends beyond this Congress.

We welcome you and invite you to be part of this collective learning experience.

WHY AN OFFICIAL TRAINING AND KNOWLEDGE EXCHANGE PROGRAM?

This Program is built on **four fundamental pillars** that guide every learning experience and the exchange among rangers.

1



PEER-TO-PEER LEARNING

We recognize the value of knowledge built in the field, and we encourage rangers to teach and learn from other rangers.

2



STRENGTHEN THE COMMUNITY

We build capacities to face the profession's challenges together, strengthening our identity, collaborative work, and mutual support.

3



EXCHANGE KNOWLEDGE

We foster the exchange of experiences, approaches, and good practices across different territories, cultures, and conservation contexts.

4



BUILD A LEGACY

We leave a mark for future generations of rangers, helping build a stronger profession, recognized and committed to life and the land.



PARTICIPANTS
Rangers from Latin America and around the world.



LANGUAGE
Spanish



COST
Free



SPOTS
Limited



REGISTRATION
Dates and procedure will be announced soon.

OFFICIAL TRAINING AND KNOWLEDGE EXCHANGE PROGRAM
WORLD RANGER CONGRESS IGUAZÚ 2027

Learning Experience I

Safety and Enforcement in Rural and Natural Environments

Strengthening rangers' capacities to prevent and control environmental offenses



 Program: Pre-Congress

 Duration: 2 days, April 17–18, 2027 

Language: Spanish

 Spots: Limited

 Cost: Free

 Participant contribution: lodging and meals

 [Click to access: Course registration](#)
[Safety and Enforcement in Rural and Natural Environments](#)

Effective protection of protected areas requires rangers who are prepared to act safely, with sound judgment and knowledge of the legal framework. This training provides practical tools to strengthen enforcement, control, and intervention capacities in response to environmental offenses affecting natural and rural environments.

Drawing on real situations and case studies, participants will explore fundamental aspects such as the ranger's role as an enforcement authority, the planning of control operations, safety in actions during interventions, the preservation of evidence, and the administrative procedures related to environmental enforcement.

The proposal combines technical content with hands-on exercises, encouraging the analysis of real-world scenarios and the exchange of experiences among colleagues from different countries.

What will you learn?

- o Understand the context of environmental crimes and the legal tools available to address them.
- o Strengthen the ranger's role as an agent of protection and enforcement.
- o Plan and carry out control operations in rural and natural environments.
- o Apply tactical safety criteria and risk management during interventions.
- o Properly complete reports, preserve evidence, and understand the basic principles of investigating environmental offenses.
- o Develop skills for communication, conflict resolution, and interaction with different users of protected areas.

Methodology

This training combines theoretical presentations, case analysis, participatory workshops, and hands-on exercises, encouraging the exchange of experiences and the application of knowledge to real situations from rangers' everyday work.

Who is it for?

Rangers, protected area staff, and other professionals involved in conservation who carry out control, enforcement, surveillance, and operational management tasks in natural and rural environments.

RANGER INSTRUCTOR

LUCAS ÁNGEL AROS

A ranger with the Protected Natural Areas System of the Province of Mendoza (Argentina), with more than twenty years of experience in the protection, enforcement, and operational management of protected areas.

Throughout his career he has served in various natural areas of high conservation value, including Aconcagua Provincial Park, Laguna del Diamante Reserve, La Payunia, Telteca Forest,



Manzano Histórico, and Llanquihue Wetland, specializing in enforcement procedures, environmental control, and natural resource management.

He holds a degree in Nature Conservation and Ecoregional Development from the Universidad Nacional de Misiones, a degree in Environmental Sciences from the Universidad Tecnológica Nacional, and a degree in Geography and History from the Universidad Tecnológica de México. He is also a Senior Technician in Nature Conservation and Protected Natural Areas, and holds postgraduate studies in Protected Area Management and Biological Corridors (CATIE, Costa Rica) and in Protected Area Management and Natural Resource Conservation (Universidad Autónoma de Yucatán, Mexico).

His experience combines hands-on fieldwork with training, consulting, and academic support, bringing a solid perspective on environmental enforcement and protected area management.

Learning Experience II

Wildfire Prevention and Firefighting

National Parks Administration



-  Program: Pre-Congress
-  Duration: 5 days, April 14–18, 2026
-  Language: Spanish
-  Spots: Limited
-  Cost: Free
-  Participant contribution: lodging and meals

► [Click to access:](#) [Wildland firefighter course registration](#)

Overview

Wildfires and rural fires are a socio-environmental problem that causes serious damage to the environment and negatively impacts

the economy. Because they mostly occur in remote areas that are difficult to access, the challenges of fighting them are even greater.

In this context, fire management tasks are of great importance and involve hard, risky work for those who carry them out, as they are exposed to high temperatures, combustion gases, and rugged terrain, among other difficulties. Specific training is therefore required to meet the demands of wildfire firefighting work.

Contents

UNIT 1: FIRE

Definition of fire. The fire triangle.

Stages of combustion. Ways heat spreads. Wildfire.

Stages and parts of a fire.

UNIT 2: FOREST FUELS

Definition of forest fuels.

Classification by state, location, and size.



UNIT 3: FIRE BEHAVIOR

The fire behavior triangle. Fuels: continuity, load, compactness, density, chemical substances, moisture, size, and shape. Topography: elevation, exposure, slope, and relief.

Weather: temperature, relative humidity, wind, precipitation, and clouds.

UNIT 4: FIREFIGHTING PRINCIPLES AND METHODS

Firefighting principles. Firefighting methods: direct method, indirect method, and parallel method. Defense lines. Control lines

UNIT 5: FIREFIGHTING TOOLS

Hand tools: digging tools. Backpack pump. Drip torch.

Mechanical tools: engines. Cutting systems. Equipment operation. Water pumping and application equipment: pump trucks. Accessories. Operation. Hose lines. Installation and special layout of hose lines.

Efficient use of water.

Aerial resources: airplanes. Helicopters.

Heavy machinery. Use of tools in firefighting.

UNIT 6: FIREFIGHTING ORGANIZATION

Organization according to different levels of complexity. Simple complexity – crew. Medium complexity – brigade. High complexity – large-scale fire.

UNIT 7: COMMUNICATIONS

Introduction, characteristics of communications. Communication system, equipment. Communication codes. Use, precautions, and maintenance.

UNIT 8: SAFETY

Safety equipment: personal protective equipment. Specific protective equipment. General precautions. Safety in operations involving aircraft and heavy machinery. Safety regulations and hazardous situations. First aid. Physical preparation of firefighters.

INSTRUCTOR

IVÁN FABRICIO RODAS

Wildfire, communications, and emergency response brigade member at Iguazú National Park (Argentina), with experience in fire management and first response in protected areas, serving as a reference within the protected area on communications and meteorology applied to firefighting.



He is a Professor of Information and Communication Technology and holds a Diploma in Fire Management and Climate Change from the Universidad Nacional de San Martín. He complements his operational experience with a certification in Training of Trainers in Workplace Skills issued by the Argentine Forestry Association (AFOA) together with the Ministry of Labor, Employment and Social Security, bringing a pedagogical, technical, and safety-focused approach to firefighting and to training new members joining firefighting brigades.

Learning Experience III

Comprehensive Management of Protected Areas

📍 Program: Post-Congress ⓘ

Duration: 4 days, April 24–27, 2027

🌐 Language: Spanish

👥 Spots: Limited

💰 Cost: Free

🏠 Participant contribution:
lodging and meals



▶ [Click to access: Comprehensive Management of Protected Areas course registration](#)

Overview

Managing protected areas and other conservation areas requires integrating technical knowledge, planning capacity, and management tools capable of meeting increasingly complex challenges. Protection and control, visitor management, operational coordination, and Integrated Fire Management are all part of rangers' everyday work..

This learning experience aims to strengthen these competencies based on real experiences carried out in protected areas of Costa Rica, promoting the exchange of knowledge among rangers from different countries, through a practical, participatory approach focused on on-the-ground application. Based on the proposal's supporting rationale.



GENERAL OBJECTIVE

Strengthen rangers' capacities for the comprehensive management of protected areas and other conservation areas by developing skills in protection and control, visitor management, operational management, and Integrated Fire Management.

Specific objectives

- o Strengthen capacities to plan and carry out protection and control actions.
- o Improve public-use management and visitor services.
- o Share tools for operational planning and management.
- o Analyze the application of Integrated Fire Management as a conservation tool.
- o Promote the exchange of experiences and good practices among rangers.

Contents

DAY 1: PROTECTION AND CONTROL OF PROTECTED AREAS

- o Ranger duties.
- o Threat management.
- o Surveillance and patrolling.
- o Risk management.
- o Case studies.

DAY 2: OPERATIONAL MANAGEMENT

- o Operational planning.
- o Work organization.
- o Resource management.
- o Inter-institutional coordination.
- o Decision-making.
- o Operational leadership.

DAY 3: VISITOR MANAGEMENT AND SUSTAINABLE TOURISM

- o Public use.
- o Visitor services.
- o Quality of experience.
- o Manage conflicts.
- o Sustainable tourism.
- o Visitor interpretation.

DAY 4: INTEGRATED FIRE MANAGEMENT

- o IFM principles.
- o Prevention.
- o Preparedness.
- o Institutional coordination.
- o Personnel safety.
- o Lessons learned.
- o Climate change adaptation.

Methodology

- | | |
|--------------------------------|--|
| □ Participatory presentations. | □ Simulations. |
| □ Case studies. | □ Activity planning. |
| □ Problem-solving. | □ Exchange of experiences among rangers. |
| □ Group exercises. | |

Who is it for?

Rangers, protected area staff, and other conservation professionals interested in strengthening their capacities for the comprehensive management of protected areas.

What makes this experience unique

It integrates four core competencies for rangers' everyday work — protection and control, operational management, visitor management, and Integrated Fire Management — through an approach based on real experiences and focused on practical application across different conservation contexts.

RANGER INSTRUCTOR

RANGER MARCO BUSTOS SALAZAR

Brief profile: A Costa Rican professional with postgraduate training in Environmental Management and Sustainable Development and in Sustainable Tourism Management. He has extensive experience in the management of protected wilderness areas, coordination of Integrated Fire Management programs, protection and control, public-use management, and sustainable tourism. He has worked as a university lecturer and trainer, taking part in capacity-building processes for staff involved in conservation and protected area management.



Learning Experience IV

WILDERNESS FIRST AID

Wilderness First Aid | WFA

-  Program: Post-Congress
-  Duration: 5 days, April 24–28, 2027
-  Language: Spanish
-  Spots: Limited, 30 participants
-  Cost: Free
-  [Participant contribution: lodging and meals. Click to](#)
-  [access: WFA course registration](#)



Contents

DAY 1

- ☐ Overview (0.25 h)
- ☐ Introduction to remote first aid (0.50 h)
- ☐ Ethical and legal aspects (0.50 h)
- ☐ Basic concepts of anatomy and physiology (0.75 h)
- ☐ Patient assessment chain (1.75 h)

- Airway management in patients with spinal injury (0.50 h)
- CPR – choking/airway obstruction, theory and practice (1.00 h)
- AED, theory and practice (1.00 h)
- Bleeding (0.50 h)
- Cardiovascular emergencies (0.75 h)
- Fainting and the AVPU scale (0.50 h)
- Hands-on practice and video review (1.00 h)
- Total: 9 h

DAY 2

- Secondary assessment, theory (0.75 h)
- Soft tissue injuries (0.50 h)
- Mechanism of injury (0.50 h)
- Spinal injuries (0.75 h)
- Hands-on practice: managing patients with spinal injury (1.00 h)
- Head injuries (0.75 h)
- Bone, joint, and muscle injuries + dressings and bandages (1.75 h)
- Burns (0.50 h)
- Thermoregulation (0.50 h)
- Hyperthermia (0.50 h)
- Hypothermia (0.50 h)
- Hands-on practice and video review (1.00 h)
- Total: 9 h

DAY 3

- SOAP note (1.00 h)
- Soft tissue infections (0.50 h)
- Managing soft tissue injuries (1.00 h)
- Spine board (1.00 h)
- Building a hypothermia wrap (0.50 h)
- Altitude illness, general aspects (0.50 h)
- Human and animal bites (0.50 h)
- Overview of medical emergencies (0.75 h)
- First aid kit and medical equipment (0.75 h)
- Hands-on practice and video review (2.00 h)
- Total: 8.5 h

DAY 4

- Review of the previous day (0.50 h)
- Shock (0.75 h)
- Facial injuries (0.75 h)
- Protocol for ruling out spinal injury (1.50 h)
- Chest injuries (0.75 h)
- Abdominal and pelvic injuries (0.75 h)
- Transport techniques and improvised stretchers (1.00 h)
- Hands-on practice and video review (1.00 h)
- Full-scale daytime simulation drill (2.00 h)
- Total: 9 h

DAY 5

- Review of the previous day (0.25 h)
- Spinal injury, case resolution (0.50 h) □ Frostbite (0.50 h)
- Non-freezing cold injuries (0.50 h)
- Hypothermia and frostbite, case discussion (0.75 h)
- Altitude illness, HAPE and HACE (0.75 h)
- Respiratory problems (0.75 h)
- Abdominal emergencies (0.75 h)
- Diabetic emergencies (0.75 h)
- Neurological problems (0.25 h)
- Genitourinary problems (0.25 h)
- Allergic reactions and anaphylaxis, EPIPEN (0.50 h)
- Hands-on practice and video review (1.50 h)
- Total: 8 h

RANGER INSTRUCTOR

Santiago Nicolás Gorini, a ranger with the National Parks Administration of Argentina, with extensive experience coordinating teams, operational management, and training in protected areas. Throughout his career, he has held leadership roles



at Formosa Nature Reserve, Lanín National Park, and Iguazú National Park, standing out in task planning, team leadership, and the management of complex situations. He also worked at the Laguna de los Pozuelos Natural Monument and took part in the 2015 Antarctic campaign at Orcadas Antarctic Base, engaging in research and logistical support, teamwork in isolated environments, and the management of critical situations.

He is a Technician in Protected Area Administration (CFyCAP) and a certified WFR, WAFA, and WFA Instructor. He also holds an International Diploma in Mediation, Negotiation, and Conflict Resolution in Crisis Situations.

He complements his training with advanced studies in Social Psychology and a degree in Ecoregional Conservation and Development from the Universidad Nacional de Misiones, both nearing completion.

His experience combines hands-on fieldwork with the training and development of human resources. He has worked as an instructor at CFyCAP and in wilderness first-aid courses, specializing in teamwork, leadership, interpersonal communication, conflict resolution, mediation, and emergency management in protected areas, bringing an integrative perspective to strengthening conservation and management teams.

RANGER INSTRUCTOR

Emilio Daher

A ranger with the National Parks Administration since 2002, he has worked from north to south across a wide range of parks and environments. Since 2018 he has been a Wilderness First Response Instructor (WFR and WFA) and a CPR and AED instructor certified by AIDER (Canada). He is also a Professional Paramedic in Prehospital Trauma Emergencies and Urgent Care (Universidad Católica de Santiago del Estero – BADRA Institution, Córdoba). Since 2018 he has been training rangers throughout Argentina.

He holds a University Technician degree in Protected Area Administration (Universidad Nacional de Tucumán), a Master's degree in Wildlife Management and Conservation (Universidad Nacional de Córdoba), a Specialization in Environmental Restoration (Universidad Nacional de Córdoba), and a Diploma in Emergency Psychology, Self-Care, and Preventive Support for Victims and Personnel Involved in Crises, Emergencies, and Disasters (Universidad Católica de Cuyo – San Luis).

General Information

How to Participate?

The courses are designed for rangers attending the 11th World Ranger Congress in Iguazú, Argentina.

Registrations will be confirmed on an ongoing basis, prioritizing applicants based on their responses.

Registration

Complete the Google® form for the relevant course. You will receive a confirmation by email.

A quota of 30 rangers per course was set based on the availability of lodging at the Argentine Army facility. If some participants do not need lodging, the quotas will be slightly increased.

Logistics

Courses will be held in classrooms at Iguazú National Park (PNI). It is accessible by public transportation. Congress attendees will receive a bus pass. Buses pass by the lodging entrance every 20 minutes.

Lodging

Lodging for 70 people is offered at an Army base on the way to PNI, in shared rooms. A contribution of US\$6.5 per night is suggested. The funds raised will be used to purchase mattresses, pillows, and cleaning supplies for use during the courses.

Meals

Meals are the participants' own responsibility. For lunches at PNI, some restaurants will offer a reduced rate for Congress participants. Dinner can be at the lodging or in the city of Puerto Iguazú.

Estimated cost of meals: US\$20/day if buying packed meals.

Contact:

[Ranger Sofía Nazar, from Argentina — snazar@apn.gob.ar](mailto:snazar@apn.gob.ar)

Acknowledgments

The Local Organizing Committee of the World Ranger Congress Iguazú 2027 extends its most sincere thanks to all the rangers, as well as to the organizations that submitted proposals to be part of the Official Training and Knowledge Exchange Program.

The broad participation and high quality of the proposals received reflect the ranger community's commitment to strengthening professional capacities and exchanging knowledge among peers. Although organizational and logistical reasons mean this first edition includes only four training courses, each of the proposals received represents a valuable contribution and demonstrates the enormous potential that exists in our region and in the international community.

To everyone who shared their experience, knowledge, and time to submit a proposal, our deepest gratitude and appreciation. We hope this is the beginning of an ongoing program, one that will incorporate new topics, new teaching teams, and more opportunities to connect in future editions.

Institutional Credits

The Official Training and Knowledge Exchange Program was developed by the Local Organizing Committee of the World Ranger Congress Iguazú 2027, made up of representatives from the Latin American Federation of Rangers (FLG) and the National Union of Park Rangers of the Argentine Republic (SIGUNARA).

Latin American Ranger Federation (FLG)

- Óscar Carvajal Mora – President
- Laura Pastorino Ladereche – Vice President

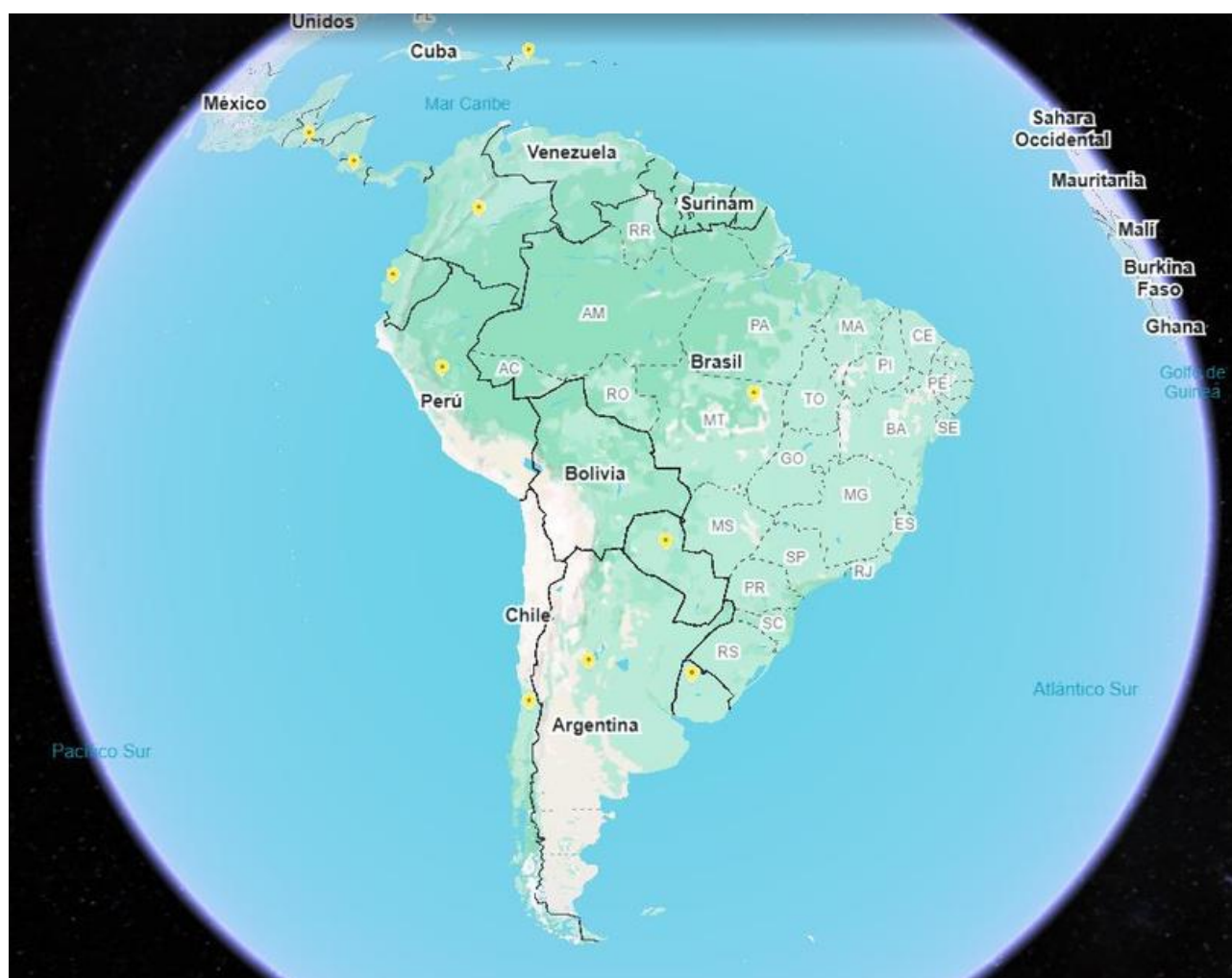
Union of National Rangers of the Argentine Republic (SIGUNARA)

- Antuel Sánchez – Secretary General
- Federico Rodríguez Mira
- Leonardo Juber
- Sofía Nazar

The Local Organizing Committee thanks the International Ranger Federation (IRF), the European Ranger Federation (ERF), the Argentine Army, and the National Parks Administration of Argentina for their support in the development of this initiative.

Latin American Federation of Rangers

The Latin American Federation of Rangers (FLG) is a space for coordination and cooperation among ranger organizations across Latin America, committed to strengthening the profession, conserving natural and cultural heritage, and exchanging knowledge among colleagues.



► [Click to access:](#) [Countries belonging to the FLC](#)

As of the publication of this catalog, the FLG is made up of the following organizations:

Argentina

- National Union of Park Rangers of the Argentine Republic (SIGUNARA)
- Federal Union of Rangers of Argentina (UFGUA)

Brazil

- Associação de Guardaparques do Distrito Federal (AGP-DF)
- — Federal District Rangers Association — Brazilian Rangers
- Association – São Paulo — Amapá Rangers Association
- (AGPA)
Amapá Rangers Corporation

Chile

- National Council of Rangers of Chile
- National Union of Rangers and Workers of the Protected Wilderness Areas of Chile

Colombia

- Rangers Association for the Natural and Cultural Heritage of Colombia

Costa Rica

- National Rangers Association (ANAGUA)
- National Association of Public and Private Employees – Rangers Commission (ANEP)

Ecuador

- Rangers Association of Ecuador (AGE)

El Salvador

- Association of Resource Guards of El Salvador (AGES)

Paraguay

- Rangers Association of Paraguay (AGUAPA)

Peru

- SERNANP Workers' Union (SUTRASERNANP)
- Rangers Association of Peru

Dominican Republic

- Dominican Rangers Association (ASODOGUA)

Uruguay

- Uruguayan Rangers Association (AUG)



This Official Training and Knowledge Exchange Program was created with the aim of growing and becoming a permanent space for strengthening the ranger community.

Iguazú 2027 is the beginning of this journey.
